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## ◆ AI Overview



The GNU `woman` command, an Emacs package for formatting Unix manual pages without invoking a background process, is platform-nonspecific. It interprets its arguments as manual topics rather than as a strict Linux CLI tool. Consequently, **it does not support GNU long-form options** (prefixed with `--`). GNU.org +4

To pass arguments or configure options, you control it using Emacs variables or `man` command-line wrappers instead. man7.org +1

## Configuring WoMan Options

Instead of command-line flags, you toggle formatting behavior within Emacs using custom variables: GNU.org

- `woman-use-topic-at-point` : When non-nil, this automatically uses the word at the cursor as your manual topic.
- `woman-uncompressed-file-regexp` : Modifies the file formats recognized as man source files.
- `woman-show-log` : Toggles whether a buffer is generated detailing the formatting diagnostics. GNU.org

## Standard Unix Man Alternatives

If you require standard GNU long options (e.g., `--help` or `--version`), you must use the standard `man` executable via your terminal, which reads GNU parameters like `$MANOPT`. man7.org +1

You can view the full documentation for the standard manual command by reading its own manual page online at [Linux man\(1\) Manual Page](#) or the GNU standards index at [Standards for Command Line Interfaces](#).

Could you tell me **what specific option or task** you are trying to accomplish? I can check if an equivalent exists within Emacs or provide instructions on how to use standard CLI commands instead.

5 sites



### Interface Options (WoMan: Browse Unix Manual Pages "W.O. ...

A boolean value that defaults to nil . If non- nil then the woman command uses the word at point as the topic, without interactive...



## Topic (WoMan: Browse Unix Manual Pages “W.O. ... - GNU

The topic interface is accessed principally via the command `woman`. The same command can be accessed via the menu item ' Help->Man...



## Command-Line Options - CATB.org

The GNU style uses option keywords (rather than keyword letters) preceded by two hyphens. It evolved years later when some of the ...



Show all



Ask anything



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## Interface Options (WoMan: Browse Unix Manual Pages “ ...

5.1 Interface **Options**. These **options** control the process of locating the appropriate file to browse, and the appearance of the browsing interface.

Missing: nonspecific | Show results with: nonspecific



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## Command Index (WoMan: Browse Unix Manual Pages “ ...

W **woman** : Changing **woman**-decode-buffer : Filename **woman**-dired-find-file : Filename **woman**-find-file : Filename **woman**-mouse-2 ... **woman**-reformat-last-file : ...

Missing: form options platform nonspecific



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## Command-Line Options

Three conventions for how to distinguish **command**-line **options** from ordinary arguments exist; the original Unix style, the **GNU** style, and the X toolkit style.

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GitHub

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## Support GNU-style long options with `=` · Issue #7789

Feb 8, 2023 — Please define **long**-named **options** that are equivalent to the single-letter Unix-style **options**. We hope to make **GNU** more user friendly this way.

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Stack Overflow

2 answers · 13 years ago

## Why do some Linux programs specify long form and ...

Closed. This question is off-topic. It is not currently accepting answers. Want to improve this question?

Update the question so it's on-topic ...

[2 answers](#) · 1 vote: I guess there are multiple reasons: System limitations: Due to the restricted memor...

[Why does \(do\) GCC \(and other tools\) not follow the ...](#) 2 answers Dec 16, 2012

[Homebrew: Could not symlink, /usr/local/bin is not ...](#) 15 answers Oct 30, 2014

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Massachusetts Institute of Technology

<https://web.mit.edu> › [gnu](#) › [doc](#) › [html](#) › [standards\\_18](#)

## Standards for Command Line Interfaces

This is easy to do with the **GNU** function `getopt_long`. One of the advantages of **long**-named **options** is that they can be consistent from program to program.

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GNU

<https://www.gnu.org> › [emacs](#) › [manual](#) › [html\\_node](#) › [T...](#)

## Topic (WoMan: Browse Unix Manual Pages “W.O. (without) ...

The topic interface is accessed principally via the **command** **woman**. The same **command** can be accessed via the menu item 'Help->Manuals->Read Man Page (**WoMan**)...'.

Missing: ~~platform~~ ~~nonspecific~~

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## Why is there only the "man" command but no "woman ...

Definition of **woman command**. A command that lags and looks through all options of what you could of meant but always chooses the wrong one.

[58 answers](#) · Top answer: and it's the command that tells you how to use things, too... hmmm...

Missing: ~~gnu form platform nonspecific~~

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